“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 11

The Branches of Śrī Nityānanda’s Trunk

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Bowing to all the bees at Nityānanda’s lotus feet, maddened by the honey of love, I write here of a few of the foremost among them.

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever takes shelter at His feet is blessed.

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Advaita! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory, glory to all the devotees of Mahāprabhu!

4 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the immortal tree of pure love, and the moonlike Avadhūta is its upper trunk. We bow to His followers, who are the branches.

5 The trunk of the Śrī Nityānanda tree is very mighty, and on it grew branches and sub-branches in abundance.

6 Watered by the gardener’s will, the branches grow; laden with the flowers and fruits of love, they have covered the world.

7 Who can count these countless, endless followers? To purify myself, I name only the chief among them.

8 Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the great branch of the trunk. His sub-branches are countless; no one could write of them all.

9 Though He is the Lord, He calls Himself a great devotee; though He is beyond the duties of the Vedas, He keeps to them.

10 Within, He acts as the Lord; outwardly, He is free of pride. He is the main pillar in the hall of devotion to Caitanya.

11 Even today, through the glory of His mercy, the whole world sings of Caitanya and Nityānanda.

12 The feet of that Vīrabhadra Gosāñi are my shelter; by His grace one's cherished desires are fulfilled.

13 Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa, devotees of Caitanya Gosāñi, stayed at Nityānanda's side.

14 When Mahāprabhu ordered Nityānanda to go to Gauḍa, He sent these two with Him.

15 That is why both are counted in both groups. The same holds for Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa.

16 Rāmadāsa is a chief branch, a treasury of love in friendship. He lifted a log that took sixteen men to carry and made it into a flute.

17 Gadādhara dāsa is full of bliss in the mood of the gopīs. In his house Nityānanda performed the toll-pastime (*dāna-keli*).

18 Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa is chief among the kīrtana singers; Nityānanda Prabhu dances to his singing.

19 Vāsudeva describes the Lord in song; hearing it, even wood and stone melt.

20 The pastimes of Murāri Caitanya dāsa are extraordinary: he slaps tigers on the cheek and plays with snakes.

21 All of Nityānanda's followers are cowherd friends of Vraja, with horns, sticks and cowherd dress, and peacock feathers on their heads.

22 Raghunātha Vaidya Upādhyāya is a great soul: at the sight of him, loving devotion to Kṛṣṇa awakens.

23 Sundarānanda is a branch of Nityānanda and His intimate servant; with him Nityānanda enjoys the playful jests of Vraja.

24 The ways of Kamalākara Pippalāi are extraordinary, and his extraordinary love is known throughout the world.

25 Sūryadāsa Sarakhela and his brother Kṛṣṇadāsa have firm faith in Nityānanda; they are abodes of love.

26 Śrī Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita has devotion overflowing with love. He has great power both to give and to receive love for Kṛṣṇa.

27 He offered his caste, family and community to Nityānanda, making Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda the lords of his life.

28 Paṇḍita Purandara, dear to Nityānanda Prabhu, moves through the ocean of love like Mount Mandara.

29 Parameśvara dāsa takes shelter in Nityānanda alone. Whoever remembers him attains devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

30 Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita is the purifier of the world. He showers the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa like heavy monsoon rain.

31 Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya, Nityānanda's dear servant, is utterly detached and always full of love for Kṛṣṇa.

32 Maheśa Paṇḍita is a generous cowherd boy of Vraja. Intoxicated with love, he dances to the beat of the kettledrum.

33 In Navadvīpa lives the great soul Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, who goes wild with ecstasy at the name of Nityānanda.

34 Balarāma dāsa relishes the taste of love for Kṛṣṇa; at the name of Nityānanda he becomes utterly mad with ecstasy.

35 Yadunātha Kavicandra is a great devotee, in whose heart Nityānanda dances.

36 Kṛṣṇadāsa, the best of brāhmaṇas, who was born in Rāḍha, is a supreme servant of Śrī Nityānanda.

37 Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa is a great and foremost Vaiṣṇava; he knows nothing but the moonlike Nityānanda.

38 Śrī Sadāśiva Kavirāja is a great soul, and Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa is his son.

39 From birth he was absorbed in Nityānanda's feet, and he constantly played the games of childhood with Kṛṣṇa.

40 His son is the great soul Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura, in whose body dwells a flood of the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

41 Uddhāraṇa Datta, the best of great devotees, serves the feet of Nityānanda in every way.

42 Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda is fully qualified in devotion; formerly his name was Raghunātha Purī.

43 Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa are three brothers, in whose house Ṭhākura Nitāi once stayed.

44 Paramānanda Upādhyāya is Nityānanda's servant, and Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita sings of Nityānanda's qualities.

45 Paramānanda Gupta is a great-minded devotee of Kṛṣṇa, in whose house Nityānanda once lived.

46 Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda — these four brothers are servants of Nitāi.

47 For Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa, Nityānanda Prabhu is life itself; he knows nothing but the feet of Śrī Nityānanda.

48 Nakaḍi, Mukunda, Sūrya, Mādhava, Śrīdhara, Rāmānanda Vasu, Jagannātha, Mahīdhara,

49 Śrīmanta, Gokula dāsa, Hariharānanda, Śivāi, Nandāi, Avadhūta Paramānanda,

50 Vasanta, Navanī Hoḍa, Gopāla, Sanātana, Viṣṇāi Hājarā, Kṛṣṇānanda, Sulocana,

51 Kaṁsāri Sena, Rāmasena, Rāmacandra Kavirāja, the three physicians Govinda, Śrīraṅga and Mukunda,

52 Pītāmbara, Mādhavācārya, Dāmodara dāsa, Śaṅkara, Mukunda, Jñānadāsa, Manohara,

53 the dancer Gopāla, Rāmabhadra, Gaurāṅga dāsa, Nṛsiṁha Caitanya and Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

54 Vṛndāvana dāsa is the son of Nārāyaṇī; he composed the *Caitanya-maṅgala* (the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*).

55 Vedavyāsa described Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in the *Bhāgavata*; Vṛndāvana dāsa is the Vyāsa of Caitanya's pastimes.

56 Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the best of all the branches, and His sub-branches are endless.

57 Nityānanda's followers are endless — who can count them? To purify myself, I have written of a few.

58 All these branches are laden with the ripe fruits of love. Giving them to whomever they met, they flooded everyone with love.

59 Their love knows no bounds, and neither do their deeds. All of them have great power to give love and to give Kṛṣṇa.

60 Thus I have briefly told of Nityānanda's followers, whose limit even the thousand-mouthed one cannot reach.

61 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.